

Monday, September 5

We have the Labour Day holiday today. We haven't planned much outside of having Augusta over. Peter started by practising cello. It is really coming. He seemed excited about it. The Fox Who Stole the Goosey Gander was his favourite today. He played it at speed using expression and superb hand technique. The overall tone improves all the time.

I worked on the writing project, trying to get it done. Bill K. wants it on his desk by Tuesday or Wednesday. That won't happen. Cheryl kept the boys busy doing something. Peter is so excited about school tomorrow he came into my study and asked me what I was doing. He then said, "Well, I guess I'm not going to be here tomorrow." He got what he came for, a conversation about going to school. Cheryl did some organizing for school, thinned out of her wardrobe, and labelled Peter's kindergarten supplies.

Irma phoned. They're bored and would like to visit. Cheryl told them to come over. They arrived at 4. Earlier, after lunch, Cheryl picked up some groceries at Hasty Market on her way to Augusta's apartment. Augusta was shown around the house and read the contract that Maureen had brought over. The boys stayed close by. Matthew put his hands on Augusta's knee.

The Peltier's came shortly after. We had pancakes and talked about their trailer trip to the American west coast, about the return to school, and so on. Peter and Sara played in Peter's bedroom under his quilt. They screamed the entire time and appeared periodically with flushed faces and sweaty hairlines. Matthew would have loved to be with them but can't yet open the door. He bangs it with his hand and yells. He is not feeling well. After fussing with him—he would not be held or left alone—we discovered that he was suffering a mild reaction to carrots in his Alphabet Beef lunch. John and Irma didn't mind the frequent interruptions at the table. Irma had brought fruit/chocolate chip cookies.

When they left I read The Hobbit to Peter. Cheryl bathed Matthew and both of them went to sleep. Peter had both of us on his bed telling him about when he was little.

I read Dune Messiah and watched bits of the Dallas-Washington football game. Cheryl sat on the couch and worked on the Games magazine. We have decided to hold off singing in the University Chorus until at least next year. Just getting back on our feet, we don't want to wreck our little bit of calm.